

Mixed Bible Translation Strategy

Zero-Budget + YouVersion API Integration

Purpose

This document defines a legally compliant, zero-budget Bible translation strategy that works in combination with the YouVersion API. The application already supports NIV, EASY, TPT, and AMP via YouVersion. This strategy extends translation coverage using public-domain and free-use sources while preserving a unified user experience and preparing the system for future licensing upgrades.

Core Constraints

- No paid licensing or publisher contracts
- Full compliance with copyright and redistribution rules
- Must integrate seamlessly with existing YouVersion-powered translations
- No long-term caching or storage of copyrighted text
- Scalable architecture suitable for future licensed upgrades

Translation Source Categories

1. YouVersion-Licensed Translations (Already Available)

These translations are accessed exclusively through the YouVersion API and follow YouVersion's licensing rules.

- NIV – YouVersion licensed
- EASY – YouVersion licensed
- TPT – YouVersion licensed
- AMP – YouVersion licensed

Rules: No long-term storage, no bulk export, no offline use unless explicitly allowed by YouVersion.

2. Public-Domain and Free Translations (Non-YouVersion)

These translations may be stored, indexed, and cached internally. They form the backbone of the zero-budget strategy.

- KJV – Public domain
- ASV – Public domain
- WEB – Free modern English translation
- VEN98 – Public domain
- DARBY – Public domain
- YLT – Public domain

Translation Policy Registry (Required Backend Component)

All translation behavior must be driven by a centralized Translation Policy Registry. This registry determines storage rules, display permissions, and fallback behavior for every translation.

Shadow Equivalency Strategy

When a user requests a translation that is not legally displayable, the system returns the closest legal equivalent while clearly informing the user of the substitution.

- NKJV → KJV or WEB
- NLT → GW, EASY, or WEB
- AMPC → AMP (via YouVersion)
- Unavailable copyrighted versions → AI paraphrase mode

Fallback Algorithm

If requested translation is YouVersion-licensed, fetch via YouVersion API. If public-domain or free, fetch from internal database. If restricted, return mapped equivalent with a disclaimer. If no equivalent exists, return a paraphrased explanation of the verse.

User Transparency Requirements

The application must always show the actual translation delivered, the source (YouVersion or internal), and the reason for any substitution. Silent replacement is not allowed.

Future Licensing Readiness

The system must allow licensed translations to be enabled later through configuration changes only. No code refactoring should be required when a new license is obtained.

Outcome

This mixed strategy provides broad translation coverage, legal safety, and a consistent user experience while operating at zero budget. It aligns with YouVersion licensing and prepares the platform for growth.